

Expense Reimbursement Policy

Company Name	TCS (Tera Company Service)
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1. Purpose

This policy defines which business expenses are reimbursable, the process for claiming them, and the timelines for submission and payment.

2. Scope

Applies to all employees incurring legitimate business expenses on behalf of TCS.

3. Definitions

Expense Report	A digital submission on the employee portal itemizing business expenses for reimbursement.
Out-of-Pocket Expense	A business expense paid personally by the employee, to be reimbursed by the company.

4. Eligible Expenses

Reimbursable expenses include, but are not limited to:

- Business travel costs not directly booked via TravelDesk (see Travel Policy, TCS-FIN-001).
- Client entertainment pre-approved by the Reporting Manager.
- Local conveyance for official work (cabs, auto, fuel for approved trips).

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- Business communication costs (SIM/data card for travel, where applicable).
 - Approved training, certification, or conference fees (see Training and Learning Policy, TCS-HR-013).
 - Office supplies purchased for immediate work need with prior manager approval.

5. Non-Eligible Expenses

The following are **not reimbursable** under any circumstances:

- Personal entertainment, alcohol (except pre-approved client entertainment), or non-business personal items.
- Traffic fines, parking tickets, or penalties incurred due to employee negligence.
- Expenses without a valid receipt or invoice, except where explicitly allowed below.
- Expenses for family members or guests accompanying the employee on business travel.
- Upgrades to travel class or hotel category beyond entitlement, unless self-funded for the difference.

6. Expense Limits

Expense limits vary by category and grade; the most commonly used caps are: local conveyance up to ■500/day without a detailed breakdown (above this, itemized receipts are required), client entertainment up to ■2,000 per person per event (pre-approval required above this), and mobile/data reimbursement up to ■1,000/month for roles requiring frequent external communication.

7. Receipt Requirements

Original receipts or digital invoices are required for all expenses above ■500. For expenses below ■500 where a receipt could not be obtained (e.g., informal local transport), employees may submit a self-declaration, limited to 2 such claims per expense report. All receipts must clearly show the vendor name, date, amount, and description of goods/services.

8. Submission Deadline

Expense reports must be submitted within **15 calendar days** of incurring the expense, or within 7 working days of returning from business travel, whichever is later. Expenses submitted more than 60 days after being incurred are not eligible for reimbursement except with Finance Head approval for exceptional circumstances.

9. Approval Process

Expense reports follow this approval flow:

- 1 Employee submits the Expense Report on the employee portal with itemized entries and receipts attached.
- 2 Reporting Manager reviews and approves within 3 working days.
- 3 Finance team performs a compliance check against policy limits.

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- 4 Approved expenses are queued for the next reimbursement payment cycle.

10. Reimbursement Timeline

Approved expense reports are reimbursed along with the employee's regular payroll cycle, or via a separate bank transfer within **10 working days** of Finance approval for employees who opt for faster payout. Travel advances (see Travel Policy, TCS-FIN-001) are netted off against the final reimbursement amount.

11. Travel Expenses

Travel-related expenses follow the entitlements and caps defined in the Travel Policy (TCS-FIN-001), including Daily Allowance, hotel caps, and travel class by grade.

12. Meals

Meal expenses during approved business travel are covered via the Daily Allowance (domestic) or itemized claims with receipts (international), as detailed in the Travel Policy. Meals during regular office days are not reimbursable, except for pre-approved late-night work (post 9:00 PM) up to ■400 per instance.

13. Transportation

Local transportation for official purposes (client visits, inter-office travel) is reimbursable with a valid receipt or trip record from the ride-hailing app. Regular daily commute between home and the regular office location is not reimbursable.

14. Internet / Phone Expenses

Regular WFH internet reimbursement is covered under the Employee Benefits Policy (TCS-HR-005), not this expense process. Additional data/phone costs incurred specifically for business travel may be claimed here with an itemized bill.

15. Expense Rejection Rules

An expense claim may be rejected if it: lacks a valid receipt where required; falls under the Non-Eligible Expenses list; exceeds the applicable policy cap without prior approval; or is submitted after the deadline without Finance Head exception approval. Rejected claims are returned to the employee with a stated reason and can be corrected and resubmitted within 5 working days where applicable (e.g., missing receipt now available).

16. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How can I claim a business expense?

A: Submit an Expense Report on the employee portal with itemized entries and receipts attached within 15 calendar days of incurring the expense. Your manager approves it, followed by a Finance compliance check.

Q: What happens if I don't have a receipt?

A: For expenses below ■500, you may submit a self-declaration (limited to 2 per expense report). For expenses above ■500, a valid receipt is required, and claims without one may be rejected.

Q: How long does reimbursement take?

A: Approved expenses are reimbursed within 10 working days of Finance approval, or along with the next payroll cycle.

17. Contact Information

Finance Helpdesk	finance.helpdesk@tcs-internal.com Ext. 1300
Expense Portal	portal.tcs-internal.com/expenses